

Board 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A Q 5 2

♥ Q 3

♦ J 9 6

♣ Q J 10 9

♠ 9 7

♥ K 5 4

♦ A Q 7 2

♣ A K 5 2



♠ 6 3

♥ J 10 9 8

♦ 10 8 5 4 3

♣ 8 6

♠ K J 10 8 4

♥ A 7 6 2

♦ K

♣ 7 4 3

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

2♣

Pass

2♦

Pass

3♠

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North
= 7

Partner bids Stayman; with no 4-card Major you respond 2♦. Partner now bids 3♠.

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Partner's bidding is crystal clear. He has described a hand with at least 11 points, which has 4♥s and 5♠s.

The decision is yours, and with no 8-card Major suit fit you decide on 3NT.

North plays 3NT. On East's ♥J opening lead West plays the ♥Q.

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Winner List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = 2 : ♦ = 3 : ♣ = 2 :: Total

You must establish some ♠ tricks which means you will be finessing through East. Since East can get the lead at most once in ♠s you should not hold up in ♥s. The problem with a hold up is that West may pocket one ♥ trick and then switch to ♣s, a suit in which you are no better off.

Win the ♥K and play your ♠9, letting it ride. Suppose it holds the trick. Continue with another ♠, taken by West's ♠Q.

West cannot hurt you. If he has a ♥ to play, then ♥s will have broken no worse than 4-2 and you will lose two ♥s and two ♠s.

If West plays any other suit you have a double stopper and can establish ♠ tricks before they can set up a winner of their own.

Suppose you let West hold the ♥Q. That's one trick for the bad guys.

West could play a ♣, knocking out one of your ♣ A K. When West won his first ♠ he would establish the ♣s, and when he took the second ♠ he could cash 2 ♣ tricks.

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 10 9 8

♥ A K 2

♦ 9 5

♣ 8 7 4 2

♠ Q 7 3

♥ 10

♦ 10 8 6 4 3

♣ J 10 9 5



♠ J 6 5

♥ 7 6 4

♦ A K J

♣ A K 6 3

♠ K 4 2

♥ Q J 9 8 5 3

♦ Q 7 2

♣ Q

West

North

East

South

2NT

Pass

3♣

Pass

3♥

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

There are several possibilities for extra winners. The ♦ Q might drop - or the finesse might work, providing one winner. The ♣s might split 3-2, giving you one extra winner. The ♠ honors might be split (or South might hold both) so the double finesse would give you two winners. Since your minor suit hopes require that BOTH of them work, your best bet is the double ♠ finesse.

You do not need to hold up on the ♥ because you will be finessing twice into North, and he cannot possibly have more than two ♥s, probably only one. Come to your hand with a ♣, play the ♠ J and let it ride. North wins the ♠ Q and plays another ♣. Win this one and finesse the ♠ again. When this finesse works you can return to your hand with a ♦ and repeat the finesse.

The double finesse has a 75% chance of success since it only requires that South hold either the ♠ K, ♠ Q, or both.

Even if North held both honors you would **STILL** have established one ♠ winner and would have the possibility of a ♦ finesse.

Partner's 2NT is lebensohl, requesting that you bid 3♣. You obey and partner now bids 3♥.

Partner's 2NT is lebensohl, requesting that you bid 3♣. You obey and partner now bids 3♥.

The cue-bid is Stayman, asking if you have 4 ♠s. However, since it was a DELAYED cue-bid it also shows stopper(s) in the opponent's overcalled suit. Since you do not have 4 ♠s you go ahead and bid 3NT.

East plays 3NT.

South naturally attacks in his suit, leading the ♥ Q.

Winner List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 2 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 2 :: Total = 7